

High-chance portions — geo-india

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Indian Physiography & Drainage Systems

~45% · Physiographic divisions · River systems · Passes & peaks

Himalayan ranges, Peninsular block, Himalayan vs Peninsular rivers — map PYQ core.

Why UPSC asks this

Location literacy is non-negotiable; river origin–tributary–sea pairs are classic.

Physiographic divisions

Northern mountains, northern plains, Peninsular plateau, coastal plains, islands. Inside Himalayas: Himadri–Himachal–Shiwalik logic; syntaxial bends; northeast ranges.

Drainage contrasts

Himalayan rivers: perennial, antecedent/longitudinal profiles, high sediment. Peninsular: more rain-fed, older broad valleys, some west-flowing exceptions. Match tributaries carefully (Yamuna, Ghaghara, Son, Chambal, etc.).

Must remember

- Indus, Ganga, Brahmaputra Himalayan systems; Godavari–Krishna–Cauvery–Narmada–Tapi Peninsular
- Narmada–Tapi rift valleys west-flowing
- Doab, terai, bhabar vocabulary

Agriculture, Soils, Minerals & Industries

~40% · Soils & crops · Mineral distribution · Industrial regions

Cropping patterns, soil types, mineral belts and industrial regions.

Why UPSC asks this

Links static geography to economy — frequent matching lists.

Soils & crops

Memorise soil–crop pairs and irrigation types. Green Revolution geography (Punjab–Haryana–Western UP) vs rainfed millets discourse. Plantation crops in specific physiographic niches.

Minerals & industry

Mineral belts drive steel, aluminium, thermal power locations. Port-based and Mumbai–Pune, Chota Nagpur, Gujarat corridor industrial stories help elimination.

Must remember

- Black soil — cotton (Deccan trap); alluvial — intensive cereals; laterite — leaching zones
- Iron belt Jharkhand–Odisha–Chhattisgarh; mica, bauxite classic states